

THE CLINICAL AI BRIEF™

Practical AI insights for clinicians across healthcare, education, and care settings

ISSUE 01 | WELCOME EDITION

Welcome -- You Are in the Right Place

You spend your days focused on people. Assessment, documentation, treatment planning, education, care coordination -- the work is relentless and meaningful. And now, a new layer has arrived: artificial intelligence.

You may have questions. You probably have some skepticism. Both are healthy.

The Clinical AI Brief exists for clinicians exactly like you (SLPs, OTs, PTs, social workers, rehabilitation professionals, healthcare educators as well as allied health care assistants) who want to understand AI on their own terms, without the hype, without the jargon, and without having to become a tech expert to keep up.

What you will get from this newsletter:

One practical AI insight per issue -- brief, relevant, and applicable to your real clinical world.

Honest takes on what AI can and cannot do in clinical and educational settings.

Tools, strategies, and questions worth asking as AI continues to shape healthcare.

A community of practice for clinicians navigating this landscape together.

This Issue: AI Is Already in Your Workflow -- Here Is What That Means

If you have used dictation software, a smart scheduling tool, an AI-assisted documentation platform, or even a grammar suggestion in your notes, you have already worked alongside AI. It did not announce itself. It just showed up.

This quiet arrival is exactly why it matters to pay attention now. The question is not whether AI will enter clinical practice. It already has. The better question is: are you shaping how it is used, or are you inheriting decisions made by someone else?

THE ONE THING TO KNOW THIS ISSUE

AI tools designed for clinical documentation, such as ambient listening platforms that auto-generate notes, are being adopted across hospital systems, private practices, and school-based settings at a pace most clinicians have not yet registered. Some are saving clinicians 30 to 60 minutes per day. Others are raising real concerns about accuracy, bias, and accountability.

Your role as a clinician does not shrink with these tools. It becomes more important. Someone has to review the output, catch the errors, and take responsibility for "what" goes in the record. That person is you.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR YOUR PRACTICE

- AI documentation tools are already embedded in many Electronic Health Record (EHR) and practice management systems.
- Regulatory and ethical guidance on AI in clinical settings is still evolving -- meaning clinicians who stay informed now will be ahead.
- Understanding the basics of how these tools work helps you ask better questions of your employer, your software vendor, and your professional association.

Your Reflection for This Week

Think about one routine in your workday -- scheduling, documentation, progress notes, home program creation -- and ask yourself: Is AI already touching this? If so, do I understand how it works, and do I trust its output?

You do not need an answer yet. Just the habit of asking the question.

Thank you for being here. This newsletter is built by clinicians, for clinicians.

Questions, thoughts, or a topic you want us to cover? Write to us: newsletter@clinicalaicollective.net

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